

results are similar, making access to Internet content as easy as it is to zap from one television channel to another.

Blu-ray phenomenon

The Blu-ray disk is emerging as a fully tried and tested media platform, backed by a wider choice of (international) films and other media content, online access and an extensive range of playback units. Many different varieties and designs of Blu-ray player will soon be available as standalone components, including extremely flat units.

Wireless at home

Thanks to the growing influence of the wireless high-definition (HD) standard, HD images can now be transferred to the screen wirelessly, without any compression and with HD multichannel sound. Reports indicate that over short distances of

IFA Berlin 2009

You can expect to witness all these technologies (and much more) at IFA 2009. The event is scheduled to be held at Berlin's Trade Fair grounds from September 4-9, this year.

20 metres the radio link operates reliably and without any problem, and at extremely high frequencies of around 60 GHz.

Wireless HD is likely to develop to augment the HDMI connection, and the first sets with built-in transmitters and receivers for wireless HD are expected to be on display at major consumer electronics shows like IFA Berlin.

Trends + +

- At homes, hard-disk-based storage devices are replacing optical media like CDs and DVDs

- Popularity of Internet radio is growing, thus creating a market for these devices and radio channels on the Internet

- For camcorders, HD resolution is increasingly becoming a standard feature

- Increasing popularity of flash drives – an increasing number of consumer electronics devices not only have the usual interfaces but also slots for memory cards, or USB ports for conveniently sized memory sticks

Overall, it seems that the gap between global markets and India has reduced when it comes to televisions and mobile phones. However, technologies like Blu-ray and wireless-at-home may take a bit longer to gain popularity. ●

The author is a senior journalist at the EFY Group, with a high level of interest in hi-tech and open source fields

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